NO ON MEASURE Z
REBUTTAL ARGUMENT

Vote **NO** on Measure Z to protect Benicia's future and keep rents and home prices from becoming even more expensive!

A lawsuit filed by Benicia voters (Morsen v. Wolfe, No. CU26-07263, Solano County Superior Court, 7/28/26) forced the City to remove from the ballot question its misleading claim that Measure Z is mainly for new construction.

Here are the facts:

- The "exemption" for existing homes under $2 million will not last. City Hall has a long history of raising taxes. This exemption can be lowered or removed.

- Measure Z taxes the **entire** sales price of a property, including the mortgage**.**

    - Example: A home sells for $850,000. The buyer gets a $680,000 mortgage. The tax is $3,400. That is about 2% of the seller's equity—like paying another year of property taxes.

- Measure Z is a **general tax**. It is **not** earmarked for police, fire, or infrastructure. The City can spend it on anything.

- Measure Z taxes the sale of **all apartment buildings** in Benicia. When those costs go up, rents go up. Tenants will pay the price.

Measure Z should be opposed by every Benicia voter who wants to keep rents and home prices from becoming even more expensive.

Vote **No** on Measure Z!

Association of Benicians Opposing Charter City and Real Property Transfer Tax Measures, a California non-profit, registration no. 19572

s/ Christopher Shenfield, Attorney at Law and Chairperson
s/ Lawrence Morsen, Retired Water Utility Executive
s/ Kenneth Bocox, 40-Year Benicia Resident
s/ William J. Groves, Retired Title Insurance Executive
s/ Melinda A. Laudy, Principal Interior Designer